



TOOLBOX TALK — WEEKLY SAFETY MEETING

Millwork | Carpentry | Interior Finishes | Material Handling

WEEK 30

Date: Supervisor:

Project / Job Name:

TOPIC: Foot Protection & Footwear Requirements

OVERVIEW:

Foot injuries on construction sites — from falling objects, punctures, slips, and trips — are among the most common and most preventable injuries in the trades. Work boots are not just gear — they are PPE, and they must meet the ASTM standard for occupational footwear to provide meaningful protection on an

TALKING POINTS — Read to Crew:

1. ASTM F2413 is the standard for protective footwear in the United States. Boots certified to this standard have been tested for impact resistance, compression resistance, and — for those with puncture-resistant plates — nail penetration resistance. A boot purchased at a general shoe store without an ASTM rating provides no verified protection. Look for the ASTM F2413 certification
2. Falling objects are the primary hazard addressed by steel or composite toe caps. In millwork and finish carpentry, the objects most likely to fall onto a foot are lumber, sheet goods, and tools. A sheet of 3/4-inch MDF falling 3 feet lands with enough force to crush unprotected foot bones. Steel or composite toes with the correct compression rating absorb this force and protect the toes and
3. Puncture-resistant midsoles protect the sole of the foot from nails and screws on the floor. Construction floors are covered with fasteners, and a nail driven through the sole of a standard shoe can penetrate the foot and require surgery to remove. Puncture-resistant midsoles are rated to resist nail penetration from below under specific load conditions. This protection degrades with
4. Slip resistance is critical on floors covered with sawdust, finish product drips, and construction debris. The outsoles of work boots are rated for slip resistance, but that rating degrades as the tread wears down. Packed sawdust in the tread grooves of a work boot reduces traction to near zero on a smooth floor — the effect is like walking on ball bearings. Clean your boot tread when

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS — Ask Your Crew:

- Q1: Does everyone on this crew have ASTM-rated work boots with both toe protection and puncture-resistant soles?
Q2: When was the last time you inspected your boot soles for wear and tread condition?

KEY SAFETY POINTS:

- ASTM F2413-rated work boots are required on all active construction sites
- Puncture-resistant plates protect against nail penetration from below
- Clean sawdust from boot soles when transitioning to different floor areas
- Inspect boots regularly for sole separation or damaged toe protection
- Never work in sneakers, sandals, or casual footwear on any construction site

Crew sign-in sheet on page 2 — all 30 crew members sign on the following page.



CREW SIGN-IN SHEET

WEEK 30

By signing, I confirm I attended this toolbox talk and understand the topic discussed.

#	PRINT NAME	SIGNATURE (click to sign in Acrobat)	#	PRINT NAME	SIGNATURE (click to sign in Acrobat)
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